

Incident Response Plan

Mido Technologies | GRC Portfolio Artifact

1. Purpose

This plan provides a structured approach for identifying, escalating, containing, recovering from, and documenting cybersecurity incidents in the fictional Mido Technologies environment. It extends the WGU capstone's endpoint monitoring, centralized logging, phishing awareness, backup, and incident-reporting work into a formal GRC portfolio artifact.

2. Scope

This plan applies to simulated endpoints, user accounts, wireless and segmented network resources, email services, logs, backups, and users within the Mido Technologies project environment.

3. Incident Examples

Events that may require incident-response handling include suspicious login attempts, privilege escalation, phishing or social-engineering reports, malware or ransomware activity, unauthorized network access, compromised credentials, or abnormal endpoint activity identified through logging or endpoint protection.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Management	Support business decisions, prioritize critical services, and approve major recovery or risk-treatment decisions.
IT / Security Administrator	Review alerts and logs, investigate suspected incidents, contain affected systems, preserve relevant evidence, restore services, and document technical actions.
Users	Report suspicious emails, account activity, or system behavior promptly and follow security instructions during response activities.

5. Response Process

Preparation. Maintain endpoint protection, host firewalls, centralized logging, secure backups, user-awareness training, and documented reporting procedures. Confirm that responsible personnel understand escalation expectations.

Detection and analysis. Review endpoint and centralized logs for suspicious activity. User reports of phishing, suspicious links, abnormal login behavior, or other security concerns should be evaluated. Determine affected systems, accounts, likely attack path, and potential business impact.

Containment. Limit further exposure by isolating affected devices or accounts, restricting network access, resetting or disabling compromised credentials, and using segmentation boundaries to reduce lateral movement where appropriate.

Eradication. Remove identified malicious artifacts or unauthorized access, correct vulnerable configurations, apply required patches, and address the weakness that enabled the incident when it can be determined.

Recovery. Restore affected systems and data from trusted sources or backups, confirm normal operation, and increase monitoring for signs of recurrence. The capstone's hybrid backup strategy and recovery testing provide the

underlying continuity capability for this phase.

Post-incident review. Document the incident, response actions, outcome, remaining risk, and recommended improvements. Update procedures, controls, or training when lessons learned identify a gap.

6. Incident Severity Guide

Level	Example	Response Priority
Low	Suspicious event with no confirmed compromise or business impact.	Review, document, and monitor.
Medium	Confirmed account/device issue with limited scope and no major service disruption.	Prompt investigation and containment.
High	Confirmed compromise, malware, privilege misuse, or material risk to sensitive systems.	Immediate containment and management escalation.
Critical	Widespread ransomware, major data exposure, or significant operational disruption.	Immediate coordinated response, recovery, and executive involvement.

7. Documentation and Evidence

Incident records should capture the date/time identified, reporting source, affected assets or accounts, observed indicators, severity, actions taken, responsible personnel, recovery outcome, and follow-up recommendations. Relevant logs and screenshots should be retained when appropriate to support investigation and lessons learned.

8. Training and Testing

Users should receive recurring awareness training covering phishing identification and incident reporting. The response process should be reviewed periodically through simulated scenarios so gaps in escalation, containment, recovery, or documentation can be identified.

9. Framework Alignment

For portfolio purposes, this plan supports NIST CSF 2.0 incident-management outcomes, including Detect, Respond, and Recover activities. The original capstone did not contain a complete formal incident-response plan; this document is an extension based on its centralized logging, detection workflows, backup/recovery, and awareness-training components.

Portfolio Disclosure

This incident response plan was created as a GRC portfolio extension of an academic WGU capstone involving a fictional organization and simulated environment. It is not a response plan from professional employment or a real client engagement.